Business Brain Guide

*Let participants mark answers **"Known," "Estimate," or "Help me work this out."** That keeps estimates from becoming established business facts.

1. Business basics

- What is your business name, location, and service area?
- Do you sell products, services, or both?
- What do you sell, and what makes customers choose you?
- How do customers order, book, pay, and receive their purchase?
- Do you operate from home, a storefront, online, or at customers' locations?

2. Customers and evidence

- Who buys from you now? Who would you like to reach this holiday season?
- What occasion, problem, or need brings them to you?
- What questions or objections do customers commonly raise?
- What proof can we use: actual reviews, customer feedback, photos, qualifications, or past results?
- What claims should we avoid or verify first?

3. Prices and costs — essential for the holiday offer

Ask owners to complete this for **one or two products/services they might promote**, rather than their entire catalog. (probably what they'd want to sell more of for the holiday season)

Question	**Product follow-up**	**Service follow-up**
What do you charge?	Per item, dozen, box, or bundle?	Per hour, visit, project, or package?
What materials does one sale use?	Ingredients, components, purchased stock	Consumables, supplies, customer materials
How much labor does it require?	Preparation, production, decorating, packing	Consultation, preparation, travel, delivery of service, follow-up
What should that labor cost?	Owner's hourly pay allowance and employee costs	Owner's hourly pay allowance, employees, subcontractors
What other costs come with each sale?	Packaging, shipping, delivery, transaction fees	Mileage, parking, rental, booking and transaction fees

Question	Product follow-up	Service follow-up
What losses or extra work occur?	Waste, spoilage, returns, remakes	Cancellations, no-shows, revisions, repeat visits
Does the holiday version cost more?	Special materials, designs, gift wrapping	Longer appointments, peak staffing, travel, extra inclusions

Also ask:

- **For batches:** What does a whole batch cost, how long does it take, and how many sellable units does it produce?
- **For packages:** What exactly is included, and where does an extra charge begin?
- **For mixed businesses:** What are the product and service costs separately?

4. Operating expenses and owner earnings

- What recurring expenses keep the business running—rent, insurance, software, utilities, equipment, marketing, and administration?
- Which expenses have already been included in your per-sale costs?
- How many sales or billable hours normally help cover those expenses?
- What additional expenses will this campaign create—samples, advertising, seasonal help, photography, or subscriptions?
- What do you want to earn for your own labor?
- After paying for that labor and other expenses, what profit would make the campaign worthwhile?

The app should distinguish **cash left after purchases**, **owner compensation**, and **profit**. Those can be very different numbers.

5. Capacity and cash available

- How many items, appointments, or projects can you realistically fulfill each week?
- How much capacity is already committed to regular customers?
- What limits you most: time, equipment, stock, staffing, storage, or delivery?
- What order sizes, lead times, and fulfillment dates can you support?
- How much can you spend upfront before customers pay?
- Can you take deposits? When are supplier and staff payments due?
- Do you need room for cancellations, delays, or remakes?

6. Holiday campaign goals and boundaries

- Which holidays or occasions do you want to serve?
- What are your promotion dates, ordering deadlines, and fulfillment dates?
- Is your priority profit, revenue, new customers, repeat purchases, or filling quiet periods?
- What numerical goal would you like to reach?
- Which products/services would you prefer to promote or avoid?
- Are discounts acceptable? What minimum earnings per sale must remain?
- What bonuses could you provide, and what would they cost in time and money?
- What cancellation, refund, rescheduling, and guarantee terms can you actually support?

7. Marketing resources and voice

- Which channels do you already use, and where do inquiries actually come from?
- Do you have a website, business listings, social accounts, or an opted-in email list?
- What marketing budget and weekly time can you commit?
- What photos, footage, logo, testimonials, or previous content are available?
- How should the business sound? What words or promises should it avoid?
- Are you comfortable appearing on camera, using an avatar, or recording your voice?

8. Leads and follow-up

- Where should campaign inquiries go: form, Instagram, WhatsApp, email, phone, or booking page?
- What information do you need before quoting or confirming an order?
- How do you track inquiries, deposits, bookings, and completed sales now?
- How quickly can you realistically respond?
- Which repetitive task would help most to automate?
- Which accounts/tools are already available, and what subscription budget is acceptable?

What the Business Brain should do with those answers

Before recommending a holiday offer, show:

- **Estimated earnings per sale**, including a realistic labor allowance.
- **Campaign profit estimate**, with overhead and campaign expenses accounted for without double-counting.
- **Break-even sales and required workload**, compared with available capacity.

- **The effect of discounts, bundles, bonuses, fees, and guarantees.**
- **Missing information and assumptions** that could change the recommendation.

If costs are incomplete, Devin can suggest a **provisional offer**, but should explain what must be confirmed before calling it profitable. No questionnaire can guarantee profit or demand. (don't have unfounded inflation/avoid hallucinating)

For usability, I'd make **Basics → Offer costs → Capacity and goals** the initial required flow. The remaining sections can be completed progressively, with a **"Review my Business Brain"** screen before campaign generation.

*****TIP/MAYBE: Each step should read from the same confirmed Business Brain. If a price, deadline, capacity, or policy changes, flag the affected offer, captions, calendar, and automation for review—rather than letting different versions circulate**